

IHCL, which pioneered organised luxury wildlife hospitality with Taj Safaris in 2006, recently opened the 35-room Taj Tadoba Resort & Spa and the 80-room Corbett Hideaway under its SeleQtions portfolio.

It has also signed a 20-room Taj Safaris lodge in Satpura and a 75-room resort in Sawai Madhopur.

Gaurav Pokhariyal, CEO, Full-Service Business, IHCL, says wildlife resorts benefit from longer stays, strong guest engagement, and higher participation in curated experiences, including safaris, naturalist-led excursions, wellness and bespoke dining.

There are more. Marriott International has entered the segment with Jim Corbett Marriott Resort & Spa and JW Marriott Ranthambore Resort & Spa, the latter becoming its 10,000th global property.

1 Outpost 12—a nine-cottage lodge in Kanha National Park

2 Safari provider SUJÁN's property in Jawai

3 Jim Corbett Marriott Resort & Spa

"The Indian traveller is no longer looking only for a place to stay; they are looking for a reason to travel," says Kiran Andicot, Senior Vice President, South Asia, Marriott International.

According to Marriott's 2025 The Intentional Traveler report, 30% of affluent Asia-Pacific travellers plan wildlife safaris, while 37% prioritise renowned hotel brands.

Andicot believes this creates an opportunity for established hospitality companies to combine local experiences with the